MCP AGENTIC EMERGENCE

A Timeless Constitutional Field Manual for Building Agent Capabilities Without Building Machine Bureaucracy

REALITY > EVERYTHING

Repo-agnostic. Model-agnostic. Protocol-aware. Human-sovereign. For any coding agent, any harness, any place, any time.

CORE DOCTRINE

Capability is not authority. Intelligence is not wisdom. A successful tool call is not a successful world outcome.

Purpose and Attestation

ATTestation boundary

This manual states architecture principles and acceptance conditions. It does not certify any implementation, model, repository, deployment, actor, receipt, or outcome. Every implementation must earn its own evidence.

This manual exists to stop a common failure: connecting a capable model to many tools and mistaking activity for agency, output for truth, access for authority, and automation for wisdom.

Its objective is portable: turn tool-enabled intelligence into bounded, corrigible and consequence-aware agency while preserving human sovereignty.

Use it as a design constitution, code-review lens, test plan and refusal boundary. Do not use it as a badge.

The governing sequence is:

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REALITY -> REPRESENTATION -> PROPOSAL -> VERIFICATION -> AUTHORITY -> EXECUTION -> CONSEQUENCE -> WITNESS -> REVISION
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Non-negotiable propositions

- Reality can overturn every model, map, receipt and doctrine.
- A capability describes what can happen. Authority decides what may happen.
- The actor that executes must not become the sole actor that authorizes.
- The system must distinguish observed facts, interpretations, proposals, permissions, execution outputs, world outcomes and human acceptance.
- No agent, judge, executor or verifier may certify itself as trustworthy.

1. MCP Is a Geometry of Agency

A tool protocol does more than connect functions. It defines the practical world available to an agent: what can be discovered, observed, requested, changed and revisited.

Surface	What it shapes	Failure if confused
Tool catalog	Practical ontology: the actions the agent believes exist	More tools are mistaken for more intelligence
Input schema	Attention architecture: what must be considered before acting	Required form is mistaken for truth
Resources	Representable world and retrievable context	Retrieved content is mistaken for trusted instruction
Prompts / workflows	Portable institutional method	Template obedience replaces judgment
Permissions	Reachable action space	Discovery is mistaken for permission
Errors	Negative feedback and recovery	Opaque errors create blind loops
Handles / state references	Continuity across calls	Continuity is mistaken for identity or authority
Receipts	Accountability and replay	Receipt existence is mistaken for world success

Field test

Ask of every interface: What category does this name or field force the agent to think in, who produced that value, and who benefits if it is wrong?

2. The Orthogonal Decision Model

Do not collapse different realities into one verdict. At minimum, preserve four orthogonal planes.

Plane	Irreducible question	Example states
Epistemic	What does the available evidence support?	SUPPORTED / INSUFFICIENT / CONFLICTING / REFUTED
Authority	Who may do what to which target?	AUTHORIZED / OBSERVE_ONLY / DENIED / HUMAN_REQUIRED
Disposition	What may happen next?	REPORT / GATHER_EVIDENCE / REQUEST_AUTHORITY / EXECUTE / BLOCK
Constitutional transition	Is this transition permitted under governing constraints?	SEAL / PARTIAL / SABAR / HOLD / VOID

A claim can be well-supported while its actor is unauthorized. An actor can be authenticated while the claim remains unsupported. Neither condition alone permits execution.

> **Truth does not grant authority. Authority does not establish truth. Neither automatically selects action.**

3. Seven Provenance Classes

Every input that can change a decision must declare where it came from. Never allow a client or model to fill trusted runtime truth.

Class	Meaning	Trust rule
MODEL_PROPOSED	Intent, plan, risk hypothesis, rollback proposal	Proposal only; verify independently
CLIENT_SUPPLIED	Labels, references, content submitted by caller	Untrusted until checked
TRANSPORT_DERIVED	Connection, certificate, protocol metadata	Evidence of transport, not sufficient identity
SERVER_OBSERVED	Live state measured by runtime	Bind to time, target and measurement method
POLICY_DERIVED	Action class, limits, verdict composition	Version and hash the rules
CRYPTO_VERIFIED	Identity or integrity proven cryptographically	Authentication is not authorization
HUMAN_AUTHORIZED	Explicit consequential decision by accountable human	Bind scope, target, expiry and revocation

Hard rule

Fields such as verified, approved, trusted, authorized or safe must never become true solely because an agent supplied them.

4. Capability Graph and Authority Graph

Maintain two different maps. The first describes possibility. The second describes legitimate transition.

Capability record	Authority record
Purpose and stable capability ID	Proposer, verifier, judge, executor, witness
Inputs, outputs and side-effect class	Required identity and authorization basis
Canonical owner and consumers	Target, scope, expiry and revocation
Implementation adapters	Lease and state fingerprint
Positive and negative tests	Forbidden power combinations
World-level outcome and falsifier	Human decision boundary

A capability is real only when it is representable, reachable, tested, observed in operation and robust under hostile or stale conditions. Code existence alone proves none of these.

Forbidden combinations

- Builder + self-authorization
- Judge + execution
- Verifier + mutation of the item under verification
- Executor + policy override
- Witness + narrative rewriting of raw evidence

5. The Minimum Governed Action Envelope

A mutating action should not be represented as a command string. It should be a typed envelope whose trusted fields are supplied by the runtime.

PROPOSAL intent, target, expected outcome, risk hypothesis, rollback proposal TRUSTED CONTEXT verified actor, policy version, live target state, active lease, authority ceiling DECISION epistemic state, authority state, permitted disposition, reason codes EXECUTION exact approved plan, observed stdout/stderr, exit status CONSEQUENCE independent world probe, expected-vs-observed delta, rollback eligibility ACCEPTANCE human acceptance, rejection, revision or continued observation

Anti-bypass

The executor receives an approved envelope. It never receives a free-form instruction and then decides whether that instruction was authorized.

6. Governed Remediation, Not Machine Bureaucracy

A stop must be actionable. A system that returns HOLD for every uncertainty is not safe; it is inert.

Condition	Correct response
Machine can retrieve missing read-only state	Typed remediation, execute within read-only authority, then re-evaluate
Dependency is incomplete but known	SABAR with resume condition, expiry and state fingerprint
Human authority is genuinely required	HOLD with one decision-ready question and evidence
Evidence is insufficient and no path is known	UNKNOWN with missing information declared
Transition violates a hard boundary	VOID; do not repair the request into acceptability

A remediation item must specify capability, target, side-effect class, authority required, completion evidence, retry limit and resume condition. Natural-language advice is not a machine contract.

Autonomy test

The system should resolve what machines can resolve, remain silent when no human decision is needed, and stop only where authority or judgment truly belongs to a person.

7. Evidence and Claim Discipline

Receipts prove observation lineage, not truth. A valid evidence pipeline separates retrieval, integrity, provenance, temporal relevance, source independence and stance.

Check	Question
Receipt validity	Did the server actually retrieve this content?
Quote integrity	Does the quoted span exist in the stored content?
Context binding	Does the receipt belong to the relevant governed state?
Source identity	Who published the material?
Temporal fit	Was it valid for the claim time and decision time?
Independence	Are the sources independent or syndicated copies?
Stance	Does this evidence support, refute, contextualize or fail to address the sub-claim?

Compound claims must be decomposed into atomic, self-contained and verifiable sub-claims. The decomposition itself requires provenance, coverage checks and materiality review. A deterministic aggregator applied to a manipulated decomposition is consistently wrong.

Source-count warning

Two URLs do not equal two independent sources. Independence is a provenance graph, not an integer.

8. Tool Design That Does Not Make Agents Stupid

Do	Do not
Name tools by the transition they perform	Use vague names such as run, process or manage
Expose a few high-leverage capabilities	Wrap every backend endpoint as a tool
Separate reads, proposals and mutations	Let one tool silently escalate side effects
Return compact signal plus immutable detail reference	Dump the entire internal state into every call
Use typed, actionable errors	Return invalid request with no recovery path
Project tools according to authorization	Show every dangerous tool and rely on prompt restraint
Keep deterministic work in deterministic code	Use a model for signatures, hashes, rules or exact comparisons
Test selection and recovery with real agents	Test only function outputs

Defaults are silent governance decisions. Review every default for mutation, open-world access, verbosity, retries, authority, retention and error handling.

9. Emergence Lifecycle

A newly observed agent behavior is not yet a capability. Promote it through a governed lifecycle.

DISCOVERED -> OBSERVED -> REPRODUCED -> ADVERSARIALLY TESTED -> BOUNDED -> RATIFIED -> CANONICAL -> DEPRECATED OR REVOKED

Stage	Evidence required
Discovered	One observed behavior with raw trace
Observed	Repeat observation with provenance
Reproduced	Same capability under pinned conditions
Adversarially tested	Failure and abuse paths exercised
Bounded	Authority, side effects and stop conditions explicit
Ratified	Accountable human accepts the capability contract
Canonical	Registry, tests and runtime agree
Deprecated / revoked	Consumers migrated; capability unavailable or explicitly historical

Plasticity principle

Keep implementations replaceable while preserving stable capability, authority, evidence and receipt contracts.

10. The Agentic Emergence Ladder

Level	Capability	Proof
0	API access	A function can be called
1	Tool selection	Agent chooses the relevant capability
2	Multi-tool planning	Agent composes a bounded sequence
3	State-aware continuation	Explicit state survives connection or model change
4	Self-correction	Typed feedback changes the next action
5	Capability federation	Work is routed to the correct specialist
6	Governed remediation	Machine-resolvable blockers close without human burden
7	Separation of powers	Proposal, verification, authorization and execution are distinct
8	Consequence binding	Independent probe checks the world after execution
9	Self-falsification	Past decisions can be replayed and overturned
10	Human-sovereign agency	Machines absorb complexity; humans retain consequential authority

Do not self-grade a level. Each level requires a falsifiable test and evidence from the actual path, not a diagram or declaration.

11. Acceptance Tests for Every Capability

- Positive path: the capability succeeds under valid, bounded conditions.
- Negative path: malformed, missing or spoofed inputs fail safely.
- Authority path: an unauthorized actor cannot gain rights by possessing a handle, token label or tool name.
- Contamination path: unrelated state cannot silently alter the decision.
- Stale-state path: changed target or expired state invalidates old authority.
- Contradictory-evidence path: conflicts remain visible rather than smoothed.
- Adversarial-instruction path: data cannot masquerade as authority.
- Model-swap path: governance boundaries survive a different model or harness.
- Outcome path: world state is verified independently after execution.
- Replay path: inputs, rules and evidence can reconstruct the decision.
- Revocation path: capability or authority can be withdrawn and propagation is tested.
- Human-boundary path: the system asks only for decisions machines cannot legitimately make.

Release gate

A capability is not release-ready because tests are green. It is release-ready when the right tests are green, the live path is observed, and the result can still be falsified.

12. The Anti-Stupidity Register

Failure pattern	Diagnostic question
Documentation theatre	What runtime behavior would fail if this claim were false?
Green-test worship	Do the tests challenge semantics, authority and consequence, or only shape?
Tool-count vanity	Which duplicated tools create confusion or bypass?
Self-attested authority	Can the caller set any value that increases its own power?
Judge-executor fusion	Can the actor that acts approve or certify itself?
Receipt worship	Where is the independent world outcome?
Metric cosplay	Where are definition, unit, method, driver and falsifier?
Framework maximalism	Could simpler deterministic code do this better?
Human-loop dumping	Why was this not machine-resolvable?
Parallel-agent chaos	Who owns each file, lease and merge order?
Fake independent review	What evidence, model, runtime or authority is actually independent?
Self-sealing emergence	Who ratified promotion from observed behavior to canonical capability?

Compression: do not count tools; count governed capabilities. Do not count outputs; count verified outcomes. Do not count agents; count separated powers. Do not count receipts; count witnessed consequences.

13. Portable Execution Contract for Any Coding Agent

Paste this contract before any MCP implementation, refactor or extension:

1. State the capability independently of its implementation. 2. Identify owner, producers, consumers and side-effect class. 3. Classify every decision-changing input by provenance. 4. Separate epistemic state, authority state, action disposition and constitutional transition. 5. Define allowed and forbidden transitions. 6. Make trusted state server-derived or cryptographically verified. 7. Write one positive, one negative and one adversarial test before implementation. 8. Define the world-level outcome and independent verification method. 9. Define rollback, revocation, expiry and stale-state behavior. 10. Emit compact output and an immutable detail reference. 11. Record execution separately from consequence and human acceptance. 12. Do not add a metric without definition, unit, method, driver and falsifier. 13. Do not expose capabilities beyond the caller's authority. 14. Do not ask a human for state the runtime can retrieve or derive. 15. Do not weaken tests, hide contradictions, or self-issue trust. 16. Return READY_FOR_HUMAN_ACCEPTANCE, PARTIAL, HOLD or VOID. Never self-seal.

Primary success condition

A new model or coding harness can enter, discover only entitled capabilities, complete bounded work, recover from machine-resolvable failures, stop at genuine human boundaries, produce independently checkable consequences, and leave evidence that can later falsify its own claims.

14. Timeless Scorecard

Report a vector, not one magical scalar.

Dimension	Report
Capability reality	Declared / implemented / tested / live-observed / independently reproduced
Governance	Trusted-input coverage, self-attestation paths, power separation, unauthorized mutation tests
Agent effectiveness	Task success, unnecessary calls, recovery success, escalation quality, token and time cost
Reality binding	Execution receipts, outcome probes, unresolved outcomes, human acceptance
Survivability	Model changes, stale state, contradictory evidence, adversarial instructions
Attention	Alerts generated, silenced, escalated and actually decision-changing
Memory	What was promoted, retained, deprecated, forgotten or converted into a scar
Reversibility	Rollback readiness, irreversible information release and revocation propagation

Never compress these dimensions into one score unless the aggregation rule, loss of information and decision use are explicitly justified.

15. Final Constitutional Compression

The protocol is transport. The tool is affordance. The schema is attention. The permission is possibility. The authority is legitimacy. The executor is consequence. The witness is correction. The human remains sovereign.

Use these final laws:

- Reality outranks every representation.
- Capability never implies authority.
- Authentication never implies authorization.
- A handle is continuity, not identity.
- A receipt is evidence of an event, not proof of truth or success.
- Execution output, world outcome and human acceptance are different records.
- Governance must guide recovery, not manufacture bureaucracy.
- The actor performing an action must not become its sole authorizer.
- Every canonical capability needs an owner, boundary, test, consequence and falsifier.
- Every stable system must support revocation, correction and forgetting.
- Human attention is finite; escalate only decisions that require human authority or judgment.
- No machine may become its own final authority.

REALITY > EVERYTHING

If the map and the world disagree, repair the map. If the receipt and the consequence disagree, investigate the consequence. If the system cannot know, say UNKNOWN. If only a human may decide, stop cleanly and present the decision.

DITEMPA BUKAN DIBERI

References and Provenance

This manual is intentionally repository- and model-agnostic. Its architecture was informed by the current public MCP documentation, public federation surfaces supplied by Arif, and the uploaded prior artifact. These sources are reference material, not certification.

- Model Context Protocol documentation index: https://modelcontextprotocol.io/llms.txt
- MCP specification and architecture: https://modelcontextprotocol.io/specification/
- Public governance example: https://github.com/ariffazil/arifOS
- Public attention and agent-discovery example: https://github.com/ariffazil/AAA
- Public bounded-execution example: https://github.com/ariffazil/A-FORGE
- Human-facing federation entry: https://arif-fazil.com/
- Prior artifact supplied for transformation: MCP-AGENTIC-EMERGENCE-v1-2026-10-27.pdf

Version policy

This doctrine should change only when a principle is falsified, a trust boundary is found incomplete, or a more general formulation survives broader evidence. Implementation status, tool counts and current defects belong in separate live receipts, never inside the timeless core.

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